tom's HARDWARE

The report states the units have had their automatic defrosting systems activate, but that hackers have also configured the function — which normally runs for just two hours a day — into a continuous, forced defrosting cycle with the temperature set to a toasty 50 degrees Celsius. Sources reportedly described "a wave of heat" escaping from fridges and freezers

Early reports indicate losses are already approaching 300,000 euros, but could run into several million euros nationwide. Separately, *NOS* in the Netherlands reports that several supermarket chains have been hit with a malfunction due to a cybersecurity incident on Sunday afternoon. Albert Heijn, Etos, and Gall & Gall have had their websites taken down, impacting deliveries. Electronic shelf labels have also been compromised, disrupting in-store pricing. "We have immediately taken measures to protect our IT environment. Part of this involves the preventive temporary shutdown of a number of systems," Albert Heijn said in a statement.

DARKReading

Refrigeration controllers allow grocers to set and monitor their fridge temperatures remotely, 24/7. It follows, then, that store owners could've been alerted to, or manually discovered, the fact that something was amiss. To prevent that from happening, French sources report that the attackers extended their targeted systems' defrost cycles — where freezers intentionally melt accumulated frost and ice — so that the heating looked like routine maintenance.

According to the companies' own reports, the attacks impacted somewhere north of 700 grocery and retail stores, all on the same night. An analyst for French cybersecurity company Sekoia told Reuters that Spain, Portugal, Poland, Germany, and Belgium had also been affected, and a major supermarket chain in the Netherlands shut its systems down as a precaution, according to the AP. Just one French chain, Intermarché, reported tens of millions of euros in losses.

Worst of all, experts point out that the attacks were almost certainly avoidable with standard cyber hygiene.